A-A-54095
9 March 1990

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PILLOW, BED

(Polyester Fiber)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-P-37042 (DSA-DM) which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers a polyester fiber bed pillow.

Salient characteristics:

The finished bed pillow shall be rectangular in shape and shall be 20 inches plus or minus 1/2 inch in width and 26 inches plus or minus 1/2 inch in length. Length and width measurements of the filled and closed pillow shall be determined from end of seam to end of seam.

The pillow shall be made of one piece of cotton ticking with the strips in the widthwise direction (shorter dimension) of the pillow. The case shall be seamed inside-out leaving one end open. The end opening shall be seamed after turning the case right side out and filling the pillow. Stitching shall be not less than 1/4 inch from the edges of the material except that the stitching on final closure shall be not less than 1/8 inch from the edge. One end of the identification label and instruction label shall be securely stitched into the closing seam or the seam opposite the closing seam of the pillow. When a separate state label is legally required by the state in which the pillow is manufactured, the state label shall be securely stitched adjacent to and in the same seam as the identification label.

The ticking shall be an untreated clean cotton ticking twill cloth with a minimum weight of 6.5 ounces/square yard. The yarn shall be singles and shall be made from cotton which has been carded, drawn, and spun into singles yarn. The cloth shall have a minimum of 70 yarns per inch in the warp direction and 44 yarns per inch in the filling direction. The minimum breaking strength shall be 110 pounds (warp) and 60

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pounds (filling).

The needle and looper thread utilized in the fabrication of the pillow shall be a soft finish, Ticket Number 30, 3 ply, unbleached or bleached white, cotton thread with a minimum breaking strength of 3.0 pounds. When Stitch Type 401 is used, Ticket Number 50, 3 ply, with a minimum breaking strength of 1.9 pounds may be used for the bobbin or looper thread.

The pillow filler shall be 100 percent prime grade virgin polyester fiber formed into an even batt of an approved fiberfill material. The use of any form of polyester waste is prohibited (e.g., undrawn fiber, mixture of deniers, lusters, or cross sections, and waste from any stage of fiber production; whether drawn, undrawn, or mixed or garnetted fiber). The batt shall be garnet-opened and cross-lapped, and then rolled for consistent density and firmness in the final form. The batt shall have a density of one ounce per square foot, using polyester of nominal 4-3/4 denier and 2 inch filament length. The finished pillow shall contain a minimum of 24 ounces of filler. The use of airblown or garnetted clippings is prohibited. A funnel-shaped compression chute or other suitable mechanical means shall be used to place the fiberfill batt into the casing. The use of a blower attachment for placing the fiberfill into the casing is prohibited. Underweight batts shall not be "pieced in".

A certificate of compliance is mandatory for the filler requirements of the preceeding paragraph. It shall include a certified statement that the fiber used is that specified in the preceeding paragraph plus the fiber supplier's type and identification data supported by a certified copy of the fiber producer's certification to the manufacturer of pillows.

All stitches except the closing seam shall be the lockstitch (type 301) or the chain stitch (type 401). The closing seam shall be the lockstitch. Stitches shall be 10 plus or minus 2 stitches per inch. All seams except the closing seam shall be a straight, flat seam formed by superimposing two plies of material and seaming them with one or more rows of stitches. The closing seam shall be a turned edge seam formed by superimposing two plies of material, turning the edges of both plies a specified distance to the inside and seaming through the turned edges with one or more rows of stitches. The ends of all stitching produced with a lockstitch when not caught in other seams and stitching, shall be backtacked not less than 1/4 inch. Both ends of all seams and stitching produced with a chainstitch, when not caught in other seams or stitching,

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shall have a 1/2 inch minimum chain extending beyond each end. Thread breaks (all stitch types) shall be secured by stitching back of the break not less than 1 inch. Skipped stitches or thread breaks (chain stitch) may be repaired by using the lockstitch. Seam allowances shall be maintained with seams properly sewn so that no raw edges, runoffs, twists, pleats, puckers, or open seams will result. All stitching shall be regular and even. Stitching shall not be loose, resulting in a loose seam, or tight, resulting in broken stitches when tension is applied.

When required by state law, each pillow shall have a label attached to conform with the legal requirements of the state in which it is manufactured. When allowed under state law, the information required under state regulations may be combined in the identification label.

The pillow shall have a combination identification and size label. The contents and format shall be as follows:

Item description	S
Contract number	I
Stock number	Z
	E

Fur, Wool or Fiber Products Act information as applicable.
Supplier's name (bottom of label).

The pillow shall also have an instruction label for care instructions. The content shall be as follows:

CARE INSTRUCTIONS

Launder and dry by Formula G of TM 10-354 (Army). Tumble dry at 150° to 180°F.

The labels shall be spunbonded nonwoven material made from 4.0 denier (.44 Tex), continuous filament white polyester fiber and shall be impregnated and coated with a permanent pigmented acrylic composition. The color of the finished labels shall be bleached white. Printing shall be Gothic type. As an alternate, the identification, size, and instruction labels may be combined into one combination label.
The finished pillow shall have no holes, cuts, tears, or any mends. The pillow shall be free of lump formation and shall have no offensive or objectionable odor.

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Workmanship. The bed pillow shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One pillow, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests, including dimensional tests, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-3. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one bed pillow.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Weight of fiberfill test. Determination shall be made of the weight of fiberfill contained in the finished pillow, calculated as the total weight of the pillow minus the average weight of the ticking case. A determination for average weight of ticking cases shall be made for each lot. The average ticking case weight shall be the average weight obtained from weighing not less than 100 ticking cases in the lot. Any weight of fiberfill which is less than 24 ounces shall constitute a failure with respect to weight of fiberfill.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

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Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTES: 1. The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

7210-00-119-5358

2. The approved fiberfill products are Celanese Fortrel 7 Polyester Fiberfill, DuPont Dacron Hollowfill II H, and Eastman Kodel Fiberfill 232.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 7210-0284

Location:
CID/PILLOW/BED/H13-36

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NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-54095	PILLOW, BED (polyester Fiber)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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